



DEPARTMENT ORDER NO. 204-B
Series of 2026

AMENDING CERTAIN PROVISIONS OF DOLE DEPARTMENT ORDER NOS. 204 AND 204-A, SERIES OF 2019, OTHERWISE KNOWN AS THE GUIDELINES ON THE IMPLEMENTATION OF THE DOLE GOVERNMENT INTERNSHIP PROGRAM (DOLE-GIP)

To continuously enhance program implementation, Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) Order No. 204, Series of 2019, as amended by DOLE Order No. 204-A, Series of 2019, otherwise known as the DOLE Guidelines on the Implementation of the Government Internship Program (GIP), is hereby further amended.

1. Section 2 (Scope and Coverage) of the Guidelines is deleted. Section 3 (Definition of Terms) is amended and renumbered as the new Section 2, as follows:

SECTION 2. DEFINITION OF TERMS

As used herein, the following terms shall mean:

- a. **DOLE** refers to the Department of Labor and Employment, including its regional and field offices, which shall administer the GIP and oversee, manage and supervise its implementation.
- b. **GIP** or **DOLE-GIP** refers to the internship program implemented by DOLE which seeks to initiate youth participants into public service by involving them with government programs and projects through the various departments and agencies, pursuant to KABATAAN 2000 under Executive Order No. 139, series of 1993.
- c. **Intern** or **Beneficiary** refers to a person qualified to participate in the GIP and covered by an internship agreement in accordance with this Guidelines.
- d. **Internship** refers to a period of work experience that gives an intern qualified under this Guidelines the opportunity, within a specified period, to gain actual and practical work exposure in a government agency, and to develop or acquire sound work values and specific skills and competencies.
- e. **Internship agreement** refers to the agreement between the DOLE regional office and the individual intern or group of interns stating the terms and conditions of the internship.
- f. **Stipend** refers to the amount of allowance which an intern is entitled to receive under the internship agreement. Such amount shall, without qualification or deduction, be equivalent to the highest prevailing minimum wage rate in the area where the intern is deployed.

- g. **Partner agency** refers to any government agency or instrumentality in the executive, legislative, or judicial branch of government at the national, regional or local including public hospitals, schools and training institutions; State universities and colleges (SUCs) including their job placement offices (JPOs); government financial institutions (GFIs) and government-owned and controlled corporations (GOCCs); and local government units (LGUs) including the public employment service offices (PESOs), which has a partnership agreement with the DOLE for the implementation of the GIP and to which an intern is deployed or assigned.
 - h. **Group Personal Accident Insurance (GPAI)** refers to the insurance policy issued by the Government Service Insurance System (GSIS) or any private or micro-insurance provider duly accredited by the Insurance Commission in favor of an intern to cover risks and accidents arising from his or her internship.
 - i. **Partnership agreement** refers to the agreement between the DOLE and the partner government agency to which an intern under the GIP shall be deployed, with an accompanying work plan approved by the DOLE.
2. Section 4 (Qualifications) is hereby re-titled, amended and renumbered as the new Section 3 of the Guidelines, as follows:

SECTION 3. WHO MAY QUALIFY FOR INTERNSHIP

To qualify as an intern, a person:

- a. Must be between 18–30 years of age;
 - b. Must be at least a graduate of high school/senior high or its equivalent level under the Alternative Learning System, or a holder of a national skills certificate (NC) or certificate of competency (COC) issued by the Technical Education and Skills Development Authority (TESDA); and
 - c. Must have no prior work experience as an employee in any government agency or instrumentality.
3. Section 5 (Requirements) of the Guidelines is hereby re-titled, amended and renumbered as the new Section 4, as follows:

SECTION 4. APPLICATION REQUIREMENTS AND PROCEDURE

A person applying for internship shall, either directly to the DOLE regional or field office or through the partner agency, submit the following:

- a. Duly-accomplished application form;
- b. Proof that he or she meets at least the minimum education or training qualifications, which may consist of his or her transcript of records (TOR) or certificate of graduation; or form 137/138; or national skills certificate or certificate of competency; or any equivalent proof issued by the education or training institution to this effect;
- c. If the age of the applicant cannot be ascertained from the proof of education or training referred to in the immediately preceding paragraph, proof of age which may consist of his or her birth certificate or national identification document issued by the Philippine Statistics Authority, or any valid government-issued identification indicating his or her birth date.

4. A new Section 5 shall be incorporated in the Guidelines, as follows:

SECTION 5. PARTNERSHIP AGREEMENT; CONTENTS

A. *A partnership agreement can either be a framework agreement between the DOLE and a partner agency entered into at the national level, or one between the DOLE regional office and the regional or local partner agency. The agreement shall include the following:*

- a. The purpose, objectives and duration of the partnership;*
- b. The approximate number of interns to be engaged and schedule of engagement;*
- c. The work plan approved by DOLE stating the purpose and duration of the agreement, the indicative number of interns to be deployed to the partner agency, the schedule of deployment, the learning objectives of the interns, the tasks to which they will be assigned, and the skills and competencies they are expected to develop or acquire under the agreement;*
- d. Duties and responsibilities of DOLE and the partner agency;*
- e. Performance indicators, means of verification, and mechanism for monitoring and evaluation; and*
- f. Such other provisions relevant to the specific circumstances of the region or locality and the partner agency.*

If there is a framework partnership agreement between the DOLE and a partner agency at the national level, the regional office and its regional or local counterpart shall adopt such agreement, without prejudice to such additional or supplemental provisions as may be appropriate to the specific circumstances of the region or locality.

B. *The partner agency shall have the following duties and responsibilities:*

- a. Ensure that the actual tasks performed by the intern are appropriate to his or her educational or training qualifications, and are in accordance with the objectives of the GIP as set forth in this Guidelines, the partnership agreement and approved work plan, and the internship agreement;*
- b. Provide the intern a work station appropriate to the performance of his or her assigned tasks;*
- c. Ensure observance of and compliance with relevant occupational safety and health standards as well as protection from any abusive, discriminatory, or unethical behavior in relation to the intern/s for the entire duration of the internship, and for this purpose make internal mechanisms accessible to the intern/s to raise and discuss issues, concerns and grievances arising from the implementation of the internship agreement;*
- d. Abide by the relevant provisions of Republic Act No. 6713 (Code of Conduct and Ethical Standards for Public Officials and Employees) and Republic Act No. 10173 (Data Privacy Act) in relation to the duties and tasks actually assigned to and performed by the intern/s for the entire duration of the agreement;*
- e. Promptly submit supporting documents to the regional office to facilitate payment of stipend of the intern/s;*

- f. *Evaluate the performance of the intern/s and submit the results to the regional office in accordance with the standards and schedule set forth in the internship agreement;*
- g. *Provide the intern opportunities to be involved or to participate in relevant in-house training, seminars, and other learning activities organized by the partner agency, free of charge;*
- h. *Promptly submit required reports to the regional office, or report on any matter which may constitute a ground for pre-termination of the internship agreement;*
- i. *Designate an officer or employee as GIP focal person who shall directly oversee and supervise the implementation of the agreement at the agency level; and*
- j. *Such other duties and responsibilities as may be agreed upon by the DOLE and the partner agency.*

5. Section 6 (Priority for Indigents) of the Guidelines is deleted. A new Section 6 shall be incorporated in the Guidelines, as follows:

SECTION 6. INTERNSHIP AGREEMENT; CONTENTS

The DOLE regional office and the intern qualified under this Guidelines shall, prior to the start of the internship, execute an internship agreement stating the terms and conditions of the engagement. It shall include the following:

- a. *The purpose and duration of the internship;*
- b. *The tasks which the intern shall perform and the place of assignment;*
- c. *The learning objectives of the intern and the skills and competencies he or she is expected to develop or acquire under the internship which shall serve as the standards for evaluating his or her performance;*
- d. *The amount of stipend, which shall be equivalent to the highest prevailing minimum wage rate in the area where the intern is deployed; and*
- e. *The indicative reporting hours of the intern, which shall not be more than eight (8) hours per day or forty (40) hours per week.*

An internship agreement may cover two or more interns deployed in the same partner agency, provided that the nature and objectives of their internship, taking into account their education and training qualifications and tasks, are the same or substantially similar.

The terms of the applicable partnership agreement shall be deemed incorporated as integral part of the internship agreement.

6. Section 7 (Duties and Functions) of the Guidelines is deleted. A new Section 7 shall be incorporated in the Guidelines, as follows:

SECTION 7. IMPLEMENTATION OF THE INTERNSHIP

- a. Duration. *The duration of internship shall be based on the level of*

education and training of the intern at the time of application and the nature of his or her engagement as set forth in the internship agreement, subject to the following categories:

- i. **Category 1.** For those who have graduated from high school, or completed up to sixty (60) academic units of college education, or acquired national skills or competency certificates that do not meet the requirements of eligibility to enter the government service as set forth by the Civil Service Commission (CSC), the duration shall be for a minimum of three (3) months and a maximum of six (6) months.
- ii. **Category 2.** For those who have graduated from college, or completed more than 60 academic units of college education, or acquired national skills certificates or certificates of competency that meet the requirements of eligibility for certain positions in the government service as identified by the CSC, the duration shall be for a minimum of 6 months and a maximum of twelve (12) months, excluding non-working days and holidays.

For purposes of this Guidelines, one month shall be understood as equivalent to twenty-two (22) actual working days or one hundred seventy-six (176) hours. Accordingly, the number of actual working days of internship shall be a minimum of sixty-six (66) days or five hundred twenty-eight (528) hours and a maximum of two-hundred sixty-four (264) days or two thousand one hundred twelve (2,112) hours.

- b. Start and manner of service. The start of the internship shall be reckoned from the date the intern first reported at his or her office of assignment. The internship shall be served continuously for the duration specified in the internship agreement, unless earlier pre-terminated or suspended for cause, or unless the internship agreement allows for a staggered, broken or phased implementation as may be warranted by the nature of the engagement or other justifiable circumstances.
- c. Implementation period. As a rule, the internship agreement shall be implemented within one calendar year. However, in cases where the number of actual working days specified in the agreement cannot be completed within a particular calendar year, implementation as to the remaining unserved days may continue in the immediately succeeding calendar year provided that no ground exists to pre-terminate the agreement, and subject to availability of funds and to applicable budgeting, accounting and auditing rules and regulations.
- d. Extension of internship within the partner agency. In cases where the intern initially qualified for the GIP under Category 1 referred to in paragraph a.i of this Section but is subsequently able to meet the requirements under Category 2 of paragraph a.ii within the original duration of the internship or within six (6) months from its completion, and subject to paragraph c of this Section, the internship may be extended within the same partner agency, subject to the following:
 - i. The original internship agreement is being or has been satisfactorily implemented;
 - ii. The intern and the partner agency submit to DOLE a request for extension supported by proof of additional qualifications; and

- iii. *The DOLE and the intern enter into a supplemental internship agreement to cover the extended duration with a supplemental work plan, of such duration as the nature of the extended engagement may require, provided that the total duration of the original and supplemental agreement does not exceed 12 months;*
- e. *Pre-termination of agreement and transfer to another partner agency.* *In cases where the internship is pre-terminated through no fault of the intern or through force majeure or other extraordinary circumstance, or where the intern has become eligible for extension but the partner agency opts not to request for extension or the intern requests to be transferred to another agency, the DOLE shall facilitate the transfer of the intern to another partner agency, subject to the following:*
 - i. *There is suitable partner agency that can accommodate the intern;*
 - ii. *Execution of new internship agreement; and*
 - iii. *The duration of the new internship shall not be longer than the unserved days of the original internship.*

7. A new Section 7-A shall be incorporated in the Guidelines, as follows:

SECTION 7-A. TERMINATION OF INTERNSHIP AGREEMENT

- a. *Voluntary termination.* *The intern may voluntarily terminate the internship agreement prior to its completion with written notice to DOLE at least five (5) days prior to the intended date of termination.*
- b. *Termination for cause.* *The DOLE, **motu proprio** or upon recommendation of the partner agency and subject to due process, may terminate the internship for cause on grounds attributable to the intern, including:*
 - i. *Habitual absenteeism;*
 - ii. *Refusal to comply with agency rules and regulations;*
 - iii. *Insubordination or disobedience to lawful orders of supervisors;*
 - iv. *Willful damage to property;*
 - v. *Commission of violence or serious misconduct in the workplace;*
 - vi. *Continued unsatisfactory performance despite prior warning; or*
 - vii. *Other analogous causes.*

8. Section 8 (Program Implementation and Management) of the Guidelines is amended, as follows:

SECTION 8. PROGRAM IMPLEMENTATION AND MANAGEMENT

- A. *The Bureau of Local Employment (BLE) shall be the national program manager and overall coordinator of the GIP and shall promote, facilitate and provide technical supervision in the implementation of the GIP at the regional and local levels. For this purpose, it shall:*
- a. *Initiate and recommend framework partnership agreements with national government agencies as basis for developing project portfolios to implement the GIP through the regional and local offices of such agencies;*
 - b. *Ensure the efficient, effective, responsive and equitable deployment of the GIP budget to the regional offices;*
 - c. *Provide appropriate and timely feedback and technical support and issue advisories to the DOLE regional offices and to partner agencies, including through the adoption of standard forms that facilitate access to and implementation and monitoring of the GIP, such as but not limited to application forms; project proposals; model partnership, internship and supplemental agreements; certificates; and reporting and monitoring forms.*
 - d. *Monitor and evaluate the implementation of the GIP nation-wide and submit quarterly accomplishment and assessment reports within fifteen (15) days following the end of every quarter; and*
 - e. *Develop, establish, and maintain a central database and management information system of GIP interns and partner agencies.*
- B. *The regional offices, directly or in coordination with the Public Employment Service Offices (PESOs) and Job Placement Offices (JPOs), shall promote, facilitate and directly supervise the implementation of the GIP within their respective areas, without prejudice to inter-regional collaboration as necessary. The regional offices shall provide necessary technical assistance to ensure that all proposals are approved and are implemented in strict observance of this Guidelines and all applicable laws and regulations. For this purpose, they shall:*
- a. *Develop a portfolio of partners and projects, including indicative budget requirements and number of target beneficiaries, in coordination and consultation with counterparts at the regional and local levels;*
 - b. *Evaluate and process requests and proposals of partner agencies and enter into partnership agreements with them, consistent with the applicable national framework agreement where such exists;*
 - c. *Evaluate and process applications for internship and enter into internship agreements with qualified intern/s, and thereafter:*
 - i. *Facilitate the enrollment of the qualified intern/s in the GPAI with the GSIS or any private or micro-insurance provider duly accredited by the Insurance Commission;*
 - ii. *Assign the intern/s to the partner agency and, at no cost, issue them identification cards in the format set by the BLE;*

- iii. *Provide for and facilitate the timely payment of the stipend through the most efficient, cost-effective and secure mode of payment available in the area of assignment, including online payment platforms;*
 - iv. *Conduct random visits to the place of assignment of the intern/s, and monitor and assess their performance in accordance with this Guidelines, the partnership and internship agreements, and other applicable standards;*
 - v. *Issue a certificate of completion or participation to the intern/s, as appropriate; and*
 - vi. *In coordination with partner agencies, Public Employment Service Offices (PESOs), Job Placement Offices (JPOs), Network of Career Guidance Counselors and Advocates, and other concerned stakeholders, provide support to the intern/s through the Career Development Support Program (CDSP) and facilitate their transition and referral to employment, entrepreneurship and training opportunities and support programs.*
- d. *Establish and maintain a database and management information system, including categories and profile/s of the intern/s, records of transactions, and roster of partner agencies; and*
 - e. *Monitor the status and implementation of partnership and internship agreements, act on issues arising from their implementation, conduct mid-term and end-of-term assessments, and submit regular quarterly consolidated reports and recommendations thereon to the BLE.*

9. Section 9 of the Guidelines is deleted and replaced with a new Section 9, as follows:

SECTION 9. PROGRAM REPORTING, MONITORING AND EVALUATION

- a. *The BLE shall prescribe periodic monitoring and reporting instruments and indicators to be used by regional offices, partner agencies, PESOs and JPOs in generating relevant data to ensure effective monitoring, evaluation and assessment of the GIP as well as in tracking the employment or livelihood outcomes of interns. Interns shall be accounted for based on their individual participation, regardless of the number of internship agreements executed;*
- b. *Partner agencies, PESOs and JPOs shall submit a monthly program monitoring report to the concerned DOLE regional or field office not later than the 7th day of the succeeding month. To ensure efficient and responsive allocation of resources across regions, the regional offices shall submit consolidated quarterly reports to the BLE not later than fifteen days prior to the end of every quarter; and*
- c. *The BLE and the reporting entities shall ensure that the design, use and transmission of all monitoring and reporting instruments shall comply with the relevant provisions of Republic Act No. 10173.*

10. Section 10 (Special Provisions: Interns for DOLE Central Office) is deleted and replaced with a new Section 10, as follows:

SECTION 10. BUDGET

- a. *To ensure efficient and equitable distribution, budget per region shall be based on historical utilization, poverty incidence, population density of those aged eighteen (18) to thirty (30) years old who may potentially qualify for GIP, number of youth not in education, employment, or training (NEET) data, potential agency partners, and other relevant labor market indicators.*
- b. *Up to five percent (5%) of the total budget shall be allowed to be utilized to cover the administrative costs of implementing, monitoring, and managing the GIP, including engagement of necessary program support personnel. Subject to sound, efficient and responsive budget management, three percent (3%) of the administrative cost is generally allocated for the DOLE regional offices and two percent (2%) for the central office.*

11. Section 11 (Repealing Clause) of the Guidelines is amended, as follows:

SECTION 11. REPEALING AND TRANSITORY CLAUSE

This Guidelines amends DOLE Department Order Nos. 204 and 204-A, Series of 2019. All orders, rules, regulations, and other administrative issuances or provisions thereof, which are contrary to or inconsistent herewith, are hereby repealed, amended or modified accordingly.

Partnership and internship agreements entered into or are already being executed prior to the effectivity of this Guidelines shall continue to be implemented following DOLE Department Order Nos. 204 and 204-A, Series of 2019; provided that existing partnership agreements shall be deemed modified or amended accordingly after the effectivity of this Guidelines.

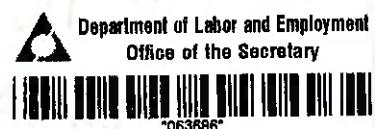
12. Section 12 (Effectivity) of the Guidelines is amended, as follows:

SECTION 12. EFFECTIVITY

This Order takes effect fifteen (15) days after publication in two (2) newspapers of general circulation.

SGD.

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26 March 2026